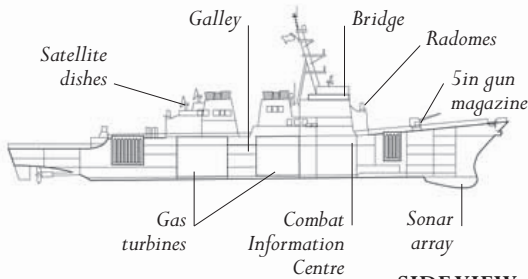


INSIDE AND BELOW DECK

Battle operations are coordinated by the Combat Information Centre (CIC). This is dominated by the computer-based AEGIS combat system, which can simultaneously engage in air, surface, and subsurface warfare. Steel bulkheads are located throughout the ship in case a hit is suffered, and vital equipment is also protected by Kevlar shields. An air filtration system helps to guard against nuclear, biological, and chemical attack.



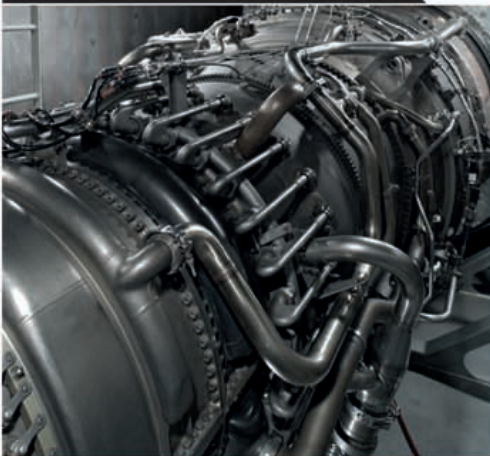
CONTROL AND COMBAT



▲ SHIP'S BRIDGE

The helmsman steers from the helm station in the centre of the bridge. There is also an automated digital steering system that allows a course to be entered and automatically maintained.

POWER PLANT



▲ GAS TURBINE

The four LM2500 gas turbines, derived from the engines used on jets such as the Boeing 747, give a top speed of over 30 knots.



▲ MAIN PASSAGEWAY

Double-plated bulkheads and interior airlock doors provide protection and allow vital areas – such as the turbine control room at the end of the passageway – to be isolated in the event of an attack.



▲ MAIN ENGINE ROOM

Two purification systems, one in each of the two main engine rooms, remove solid contaminants and water from the fuel supply.



▲ HATCH

Airtight hatches separate the ship into zones to protect against contamination by biological or chemical agents.

